User Test Report Document

Game Title Choco Survivor

Team Name Choco Latte

Fall 2024

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Table of Contents

Introduction 3
Preparation 4
Description 4
Objectives 4
Survey Questions 5
Execution 6
Yu Xuan 6
Observations 6
Alfred 6
Observations 6
Zi Feng 6
Observations 7
Alvin 7
Observations 7
Caleb 7
Observations 7
Analysis 9
Survey Results 9
Positive discoveries 14
Main Issues Found 15
Improvements, Recommendation 16
Recommendations ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**

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Introduction

Choco Survivor is a top-down 2D shooter where players must defend a target against increasingly difficult waves of enemies and bosses. The game is essentially a tower defense-style experience, mixing gameplay mechanics such as barricades and sentries to support the player's defense strategies. As players progress through the waves, they will encounter more challenging enemies and powerful bosses, requiring them to use their defense strategies to keep the gameplay engaging. The thematic design of the game is chocolate.

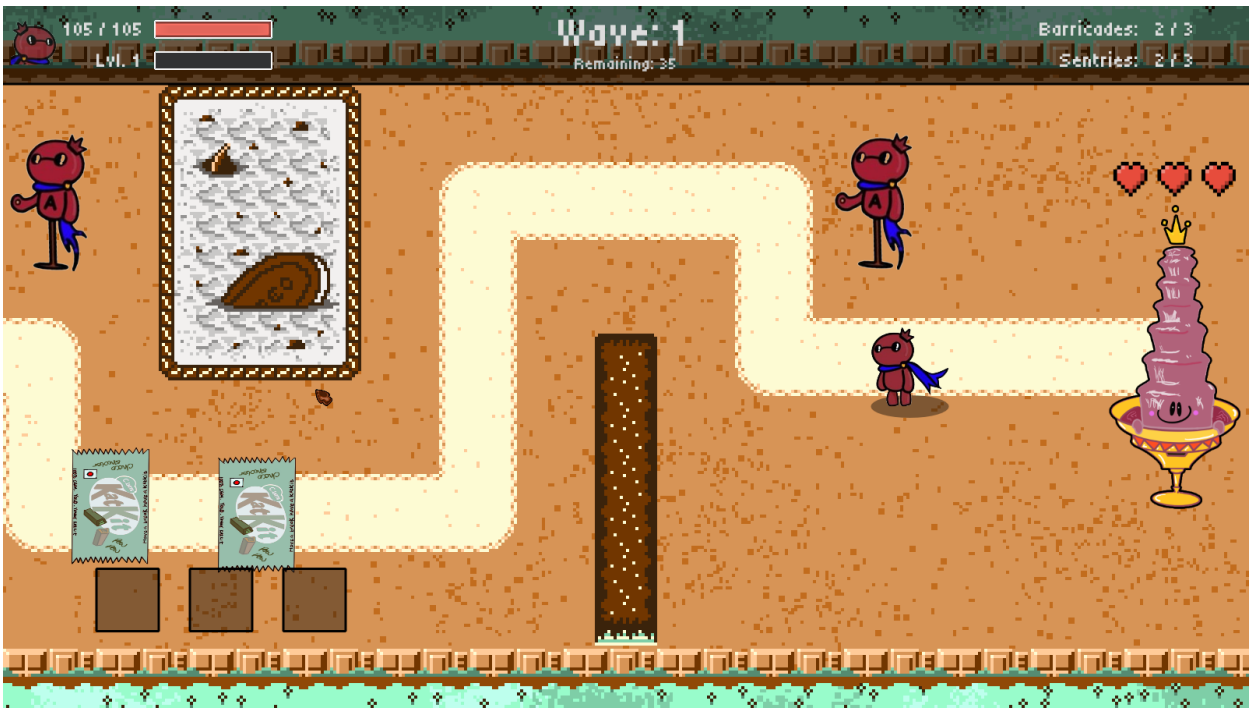


Figure 1 A screenshot of Level 1

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Preparation

Description

The current state of the game focuses on evaluating core mechanics, including movement, input feedback, difficulty, combat systems, and players' ability to engage with the game without the need for tutorials—specifically, whether they explore and discover additional gameplay mechanics independently. The test also aims to measure player investment, movement freedom, and the overall engagement with gameplay. Other aspects include the variety of mechanics, the progression system, and the overall theme, particularly whether it aligns with the chocolate-based design. Each level consists of three waves, with progressively stronger enemies balanced against the player's attribute progression. The third wave includes a boss, with common enemies around, whose attributes are balanced in relation to the boss. The structure aims to provide a challenging and engaging experience, testing game balance, input feedback, and player engagement. Certain assets were placeholders and subject to change, with the primary focus on refining the gameplay's difficulty curve, ensuring responsive input feedback, and identifying areas for improvement.

Objectives

The primary objectives of the user test were to evaluate the balance and functionality of the core mechanics and gather feedback on the overall player experience. Key areas of focus included assessing the freedom of movement, the variety of gameplay mechanics, and the level of engagement throughout the game. We also aimed to determine whether the waves and boss wave were balanced in relation to the player's attribute progression, if the difficulty curve felt fair yet challenging, and whether the progression system was rewarding. Additionally, the test aimed to observe if the game successfully conveyed its chocolate-themed design, and to identify whether players felt sufficiently invested in the game. Finally, feedback was gathered to highlight aspects of the game that players enjoyed, disliked, or found unbalanced, as well as any suggestions for improvement.

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Survey Questions

1. How invested in the game were you?
2. Did you feel you had movement freedom?
3. Did you feel that there was a good variety of mechanics to keep the gameplay interesting?
4. How engaging did you find the gameplay?
5. What aspects of the game did you enjoy and dislike?
6. How would you rate the difficulty of the game?
7. Was there anything that seemed unbalanced or unfair?
    a. If you answered Yes, please explain why.
8. Did you feel the gameplay offered sufficient variety?
9. Did you feel that the progression system is rewarding?
10. Did you feel that the theme was leaning towards chocolate?
11. Can you give some feedback and/or suggestions for the game?

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Execution

Yu Xuan

Observed by Fadzly.

Observations

1. The tester did not have much difficulty with the game, despite wave 2 being known as the most difficult before the boss wave.
2. The tester instinctively knew they could hold down the left mouse button to keep firing, whereas 80% of the testers did not.
3. The tester was actively looking for flaws in the controls and minor issues, such as enemies not following the correct paths.
4. The tester was very proactive in providing comments that they felt could be implemented.
5. The tester defeated the boss wave with ease and wanted to play more.

Alfred

Observed by Zong Han.

Observations

1. The tester enjoyed the Bloons TD-style strategy gameplay.
2. The tester disliked having to spam the left click just to attack.
3. The tester suggested that adding a charged shot or allowing the player to hold down the left click to make shooting more autonomous and efficient could improve the game.
4. Enemy drops could also be added to increase the variety of game mechanics.

Zi Feng

Observed by Dalton.

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Observations

1. The tester felt that the game was very interesting and visually appealing.
2. The tester also felt that the gameplay was difficult because the damage output from shooting was low, and the scaling made the gameplay feel unsatisfying.
3. The tester suggested adding different attacking mechanics to increase the overall damage output, making it easier to defeat enemies.

Alvin

Observed by Fadzly.

Observations

1. The tester kept failing at wave 2 but did not give up and eventually made it past wave 3.
2. The tester was actively looking for hidden mechanics by randomly pressing keys on the keyboard.
3. After discovering they could place sentries, the tester commented that the sentries did not feel as useful as the barricades.
4. The tester did not use the dash but still made it past wave 3.

Caleb

Observed by Dalton.

Observations

1. The tester felt that the game was fun, and the boss caught them off guard on the first level.
2. The tester didn’t like that they couldn’t shoot through barriers. While not being able to walk through them was acceptable, shooting should have been allowed.
3. The gameplay was a bit difficult because the upgrades were random, and some could negatively impact the endgame if they were not ideal.

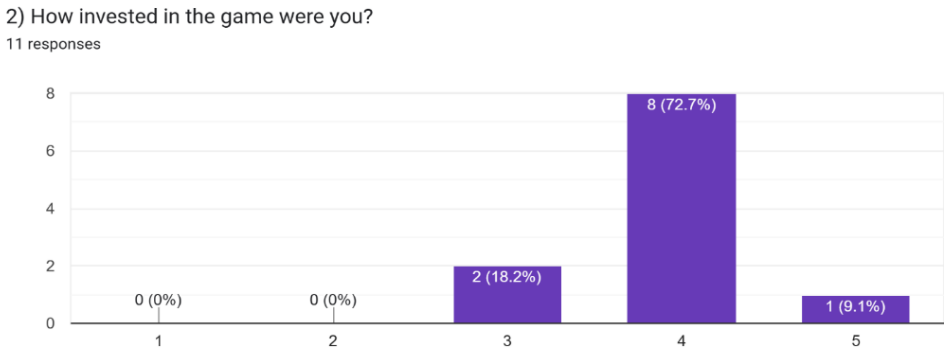
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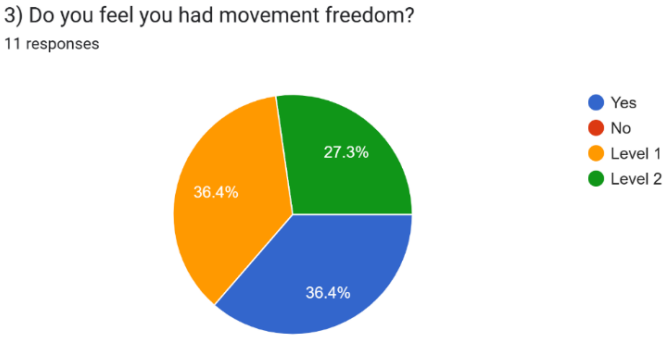
4. Overall, the tester felt the gameplay was fun despite the lack of variety in mechanics and had a good time playing.

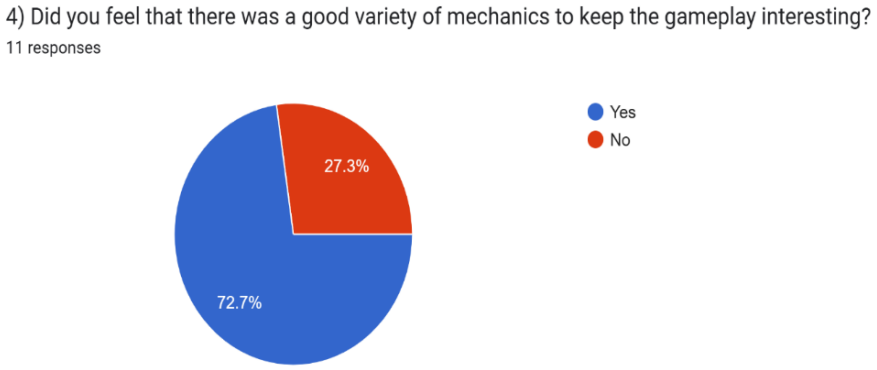
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Analysis

Survey Results



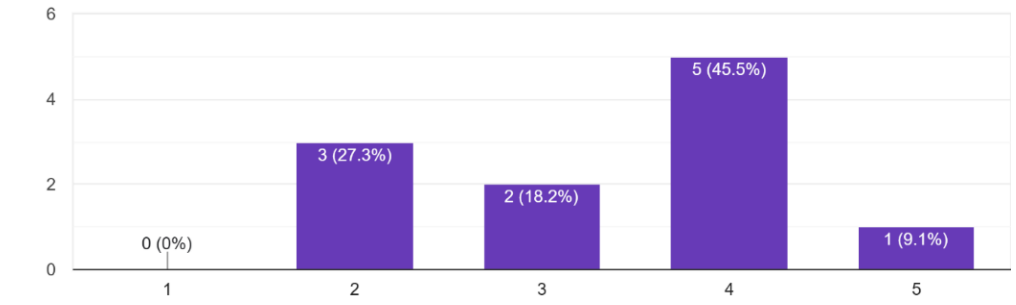




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5) How engaging do you find the gameplay?

11 responses



6) What aspects of the game did you **enjoy** and **dislike**?

11 responses

i like the visuals and the skill of pulling enemies but the attack is too low that it feels unsatisfying to shoot

Instructions are unclear, no tutorial nor prompts for controls of how to play the game, did not find out there is a dodge mechanic until after the boss was dead

We have the option to control the player, but there is little incentive to move around. Perhaps some enemies will target the player while some target the tower?

No idea how buffs work or where they come from T_T

I enjoy the part where I can get the buff to kill the enemy faster. The part that I dislike is the lack of guideline to the game and I have no clue on how to play the game

enjoy:
the art of the enemy and the powerup system.

dislike:
the enemy is overwhelming

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i enjoyed the wave system
i disliked the item placement because i did not really know how to place the item, it should be more obvious to me what buttons to press in game

I like the assets, but the obstructions are a bit annoying

I like the sprite arts, not so sure I fully understood the mechanics tho

The game is fun and the boss surprised me on the first level but I don't like that I can't shoot through the first barricade in the first level despite it looking very flat compared to the other one (it looks legit that I can't walk through but shooting should be allowed)

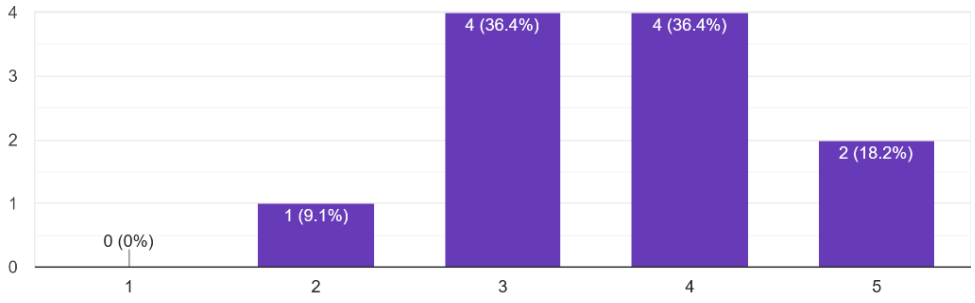
Nothing in particular

I enjoyed the bloons TD strategy type of gameplay and dislike having to spam left click just to attack

I enjoy when I get some OP buffs that speed up the killing. Some buff such as attack up not increasing the power efficiently.

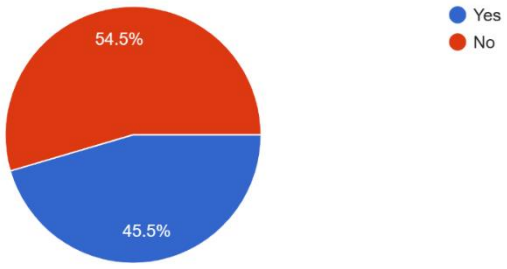
7) How would you rate the difficulty of the game?

11 responses



8) Was there anything that seemed unbalanced or unfair?

11 responses



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8a) If you answered **Yes** to question 8, please state.

5 responses

attak low

Boss performs a charge attack, but there is no indication prior

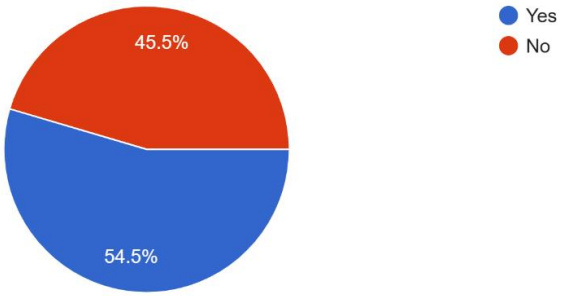
When the number of enemy get increased, it seems like the damage that I can deal with is too low to kill the enemy in a short time

Without attack bonus there's no way to clear the first level, the randomness of the upgrades can be frustrating because you need a specific one to being able to win.

Had to spawn camp to get past wave 2 which wasn't fun

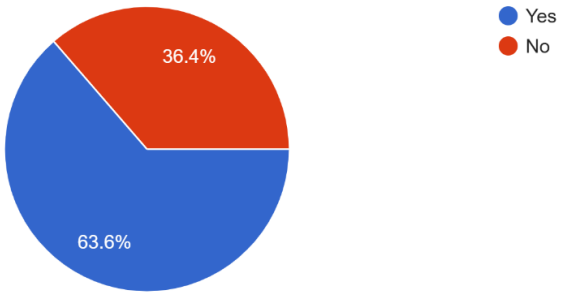
9) Do you feel the gameplay offered sufficient variety?

11 responses



10) Do you feel that the progression system is rewarding?

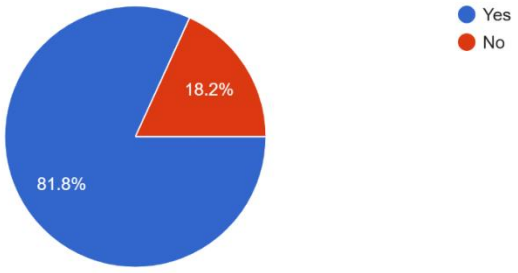
11 responses



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11) Do you feel that the theme was leaning towards chocolate?

11 responses



12) Can you give some feedback and/or suggestions for the game?

11 responses

other than attk maybe add more level up skills?

Tutorial stage to let players experience the controls
Perhaps more options for the player, maybe a melee option
Some enemies to target the player and some to target the objective would encourage more immersive gameplay

Maybe the player can see the on hit effect when the bullet hits the boss so that the player can know I am shooting the boss actually.

make the powerup more prominent to the player

the graphics are cool and cute

FUN

Instructions for how to play would be nice :)

Overall the game is fun despite the lack of different gameplay mechanics and I had a good time playing it.

It has potential.

Maybe if I hold down left click, I can shoot a charged shot/have it as an ability. Enemy drops would also help and increase variety

Instruction for activate the buffs

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Positive discoveries

Based on the user tests and survey results, there were several interesting findings. Out of the eleven respondents, nine were invested in the game, rating it 4 or above on a scale from 1 to 5. Eight respondents felt that there was a good variety of mechanics to keep the gameplay engaging, even though they were unaware that they could place barricades and sentries. Lastly, seven respondents found the progression system rewarding, despite feeling that the game was too difficult and unbalanced.

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Main Issues Found

Instructions and Goals

Issues:

1. Instructions for the feature were not clear.
2. Users have no idea about the goals of the game and did not know how to use the feature in the game.

Summary: Users are confused due to the lack of clear instructions and goals, which hampers their understanding and utilization of game features.

Enemy Design

Issues:

1. The number of enemies is overwhelming.
2. Users observed boredom when holding the button and waiting for enemies to die.

Summary: The overwhelming number of enemies and the need to hold the button for prolonged periods results in boredom and frustration.

Controls Scheme

Issues:

1. The placement of the button was not good.
2. Users felt annoyed when their hand needed to leave the keyboard to press the buttons which were placed too far.

Summary: Poor button placement requiring users to leave the keyboard disrupts gameplay flow and causes annoyance.

Buffs and Indicators

Issues:

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1. Buff indicators were not clear.
2. Users find it confusing when buffs were obtained.
3. Buffs did not power up the player significantly.

Summary: Unclear buff indicators and insignificant power-ups lead to user confusion and dissatisfaction with the buff system.

Boss Design

Issues:

1. Boss attacks seem like teleporting.
2. Users were confused about the boss's attack as there is no indicator or effects showing that.

Summary: Boss attacks lack clear indicators, causing confusion among users and making the gameplay experience less enjoyable.

Improvements & Recommendations

The key issues outlined were primarily related to the lack of a proper tutorial, which prevented testers from fully understanding and using the functionality and mechanics of the game. Additionally, the gameplay balancing was inadequate, making it difficult for testers to progress through the waves. Based on this feedback, improvements were made to the balancing, including the introduction of mechanics to ease the difficulty curve. These changes have helped improve the overall gameplay balance, making it more scalable and easier for players to progress.

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